A-A-53038
20 July 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PLASTIC STRIP, DENTAL SURFACE PROTECTION, (Mouthguard)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-P-36895.

This commercial item description covers a plastic sheet suitable for use as a mouthguard material for protecting dental surfaces.

Salient characteristics:

The plastic sheet shall be suitable for use in the fabrication of bruxism splints or athletic mouthguards. Shall provide dental patients with a well adapted compressible protective covering of the occlusal, buccal and lingual surfaces of the teeth of one arch. The plastic sheet shall be fabricated from a thermoplastic material containing unmodified polyethylene-vinyl acetate copolymer in a 67:33 ratio. The material shall be a natural color (essentially colorless). The thermoplastic material shall be furnished in sheet form measuring 5 ± 1/8 inches by 5 ± 1/8 with a thickness of 0.150 ± 0.010 inch. The edges of the sheet may be cut square or may be round. The polyethylene-vinyl acetate copolymer used in the manufacturing of the plastic sheet shall be nontoxic and shall conform to the FDA Federal Cosmetic Act, Code of Federal Regulations for contact with food.

Specific gravity. The specific gravity of the mouthguard material shall be 0.950 ± 10% gram per cubic centimeter at 23 degrees centigrade (^{o}C), when tested as specified herein.

Tensile strength. The tensile strength of the mouthguard material shall be 1550 ± 20% pounds per square inch in both the machine direction and the transverse direction, when tested as specified herein.

Ultimate elongation. The ultimate elongation of the mouthguard material at break shall be 900 ± 100 percent in both the machine direction and the transverse direction, when tested as specified herein.

Softening point. The softening point of the mouthguard material shall be 120° ± 2° Fahrenheit, when tested as specified.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

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Performance characteristics. The mouthguard sheet shall be readily molded and trimmed and shall result in an accurate mouthguard reproduction of the artificial stone model, when tested as specified herein.

Instructions. Adequate and accurate instructions for use shall accompany each package of 12 sheets of mouthguard material.

Workmanship. The mouthguard sheet shall be smoothly finished, free of flash and from other defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing twelve plastic sheets, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same samples shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Test methods referenced below shall be as described in Federal Test Method Standard No. 406.

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Specific gravity. The specific gravity shall be determined in accordance with either method 5011, or in accordance with ASTM Designation D792.

Tensile strength. The tensile strength shall be determined in accordance with either method 1011, or in accordance with ASTM Designation D638.

Ultimate elongation. The ultimate elongation shall be tested in accordance with method 1011.

Softening point. The softening point shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Designation D 1525.

Performance test. A vacuum box designed for vacuum processing shall be set up on a bench and secured with a "C" clamp. A tank-type vacuum cleaner may be used to obtain the pressure needed to form the vacuum. The end of the vacuum hose shall be inserted into a rubber plug on the vacuum box. A trimmed, artificial stone model and also the surface of the vacuum box shall be sprayed with either a silicone release agent or vaseline to prevent the mouthguard sheet from sticking to them. The mouthguard sheet shall be softened for two minutes in boiling water, and the stone model shall be placed on the vacuum box. The vacuum shall be turned on and the softened plastic sheet shall be placed over the stone model. All outer edges of the sheet shall be pressed down to assure maximum vacuum. The top half of a denture flask may be inserted over the model and pressed down firmly to insure good adaptation of the model. The vacuum shall be allowed to operate for 2.00 $\pm$ 0.05 minutes, after which the model with the mouthguard shall be removed from the vacuum and placed in tap water for 30 $\pm$ seconds. The mouthguard shall be removed from the model and the excess material trimmed with scissors.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract. .

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document.

Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-935-6607	PLASTIC STRIP, DENTAL SURFACE PROTECTION, Mouthguard, 5 by 5 by 0.15 inches, (12.7 by 12.7 cm by 3.8 mm), 12s

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Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA - DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PROJECT NO. 6520-1986

Location: NCR Disk 2

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53038	PLASTIC STRIP, Dental Surface Protection (Mouthguard)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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